Stem and *leaf* plot is a type of data representation for numbers, usually like a table with two columns. Generally, *stem* is the label for left digit (leading digit) and leaf is the label for the right digit (trailing digit) of a number.

For example, the leaf corresponding to the value 63 is 3. The digit to the left of the leaf is called the stem. Here the stem of 63 is 6. Similarly for the number 265, the leaf is 5 and the stem is 26.

The elements of data 252, 255, 260, 262, 276, 276, 276, 283, 289, 298 are expressed in Stem and leaf plot as follows:

Actual data	Stem (Leading digits)	Leaf (Trailing digits)
252, 255	25	2 5
260, 262	26	0 2
276, 276, 276	27	6 6 6
283, 289	28	3 9
298	29	8

NOTE

In Stem and Leaf plot, we display stem and leaf columns only.

From the Stem and Leaf plot, we find easily the smallest number is 252 and the largest number is 298.

Also, in the class 270 – 280 we find 3 items are included and that group has the highest frequency.

The procedure for plotting a Stem and Leaf diagram is illustrated through an example given below:

Example 3.17

Construct a Stem and Leaf plot for the given data.

1.13, 0.72, 0.91, 1.44, 1.03, 0.88, 0.99, 0.73, 0.91, 0.98, 1.21, 0.79, 1.14, 1.19, 1.08, 0.94, 1.06, 1.11, 1.01, 1.39

Solution:

Step 1: Arrange the data in the ascending order of magnitude:

0.72, 0.73, 0.79, 0.88, 0.91, 0.91, 0.94, 0.98, 0.99, 1.01,

1.03, 1.06, 1.08, 1.11, 1.13, 1.14, 1.19, 1.21, 1.39, 1.44

Step 2: Separate the data according to the first digit as shown

0.72, 0.73, 0.79

0.88

0.91, 0.91, 0.94, 0.98, 0.99

Ch3_11th Stats.indd 63 2/3/2019 10:58:16 AM